

FILE YOUR TAXES

Every price, before you start.

Pick the row that sounds like your year. All fifty states, resident and non-resident. If none of the rows fit, use QuickPrepare and we'll tell you which one you're in before you owe us anything beyond the deposit.

INDIVIDUAL RETURNS · FORM 1040

Simple	Up to two W-2s, standard deduction, one state. Tracked through to IRS acceptance.	\$200
Standard	Multiple W-2s, itemised deductions (Sch. A), dependants and credits, one state.	\$350
Premium	1099 and investment income, Sch. B and D, one rental (Sch. E), HSA, education credits.	\$450
Self-Employed	Schedule C, home office, vehicle, depreciation, self-employment tax — and next year's quarterly estimates set up before you leave.	\$550

BUSINESS RETURNS · 1065 / 1120-S / 1120

Business	Single owner or up to three K-1s, one state, books delivered reconciled.	\$750
Business Pro	Multi-member, multi-state apportionment, foreign income and FBAR, virtual currency, fixed-asset schedules, more than three K-1s.	\$1,250

ADD-ONS

Extension	Filed the same day. Credited in full against your return when you file with us.	\$100
Additional state	Per state, per year. Resident, non-resident or part-year, in any of the fifty states.	\$75
Prior-year return	Priced at its own tier, per year. Behind on several? See Audit & Resolution.	tier
Amended · 1040-X	Waived if the error was ours.	\$250
In-season rush	Completed inside 72 hours, February through April.	\$150

QUICKPREPARE

Not sure which row you're in?

Pay \$200, fill in the intake, and upload what you have. We read the whole file, tell you exactly which package you need and what it costs, and wait for your yes before we prepare anything. The \$200 comes off the final invoice.

- Secure upload link with a checklist — we chase the missing pieces
- Your package and total price emailed for approval before any work
- E-signature, e-filing, and confirmation of IRS acceptance

Pay \$200 and start

WHO THIS IS FOR

Anyone with more than a couple of forms, self-employment income, a first year of rental property, or a year that simply didn't look like the last one. Which, most years, is most people.

ALSO HERE

Two things worth knowing.

ADD ON · \$75 A YEAR Audit Shield If a return we prepared gets examined, notice response and examination representation on that return are included. Add it at checkout, forget about it, and hope you never need it.	BOOKKEEPING CLIENTS · HALF PRICE Your entity return, at fifty percent Every client on a monthly bookkeeping plan gets their business return at half the price above. The books arrive clean, so the return takes half the time. You should get that back.
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 Pivot Aide Tax Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states. 1 (571) 470-3754 6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	FILE Individual & self-employed Business returns QuickPrepare Prior year & amended Pricing The Standing File	RESOLUTION IRS notices Audit representation Back taxes & collections Unfiled returns All fifty state agencies Audit Shield	RESOURCES & BOOKING Tax calendar & deadlines 2026 tax figures What to bring Official IRS tools Book an appointment Free help & Second Look
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TAX STRATEGY · BY ENGAGEMENT

The Standing File

Most firms open your file in February and close it in April. This one never closes.

A year-round tax strategy engagement for high-income individuals and for business owners — a named advisor who knows your situation, quarterly counsel, every return and every notice handled, and someone to call *before* you do the thing, not after.

Request a scoping call

1 (571) 470-3754



WHAT THE ENGAGEMENT IS

Three things you are actually buying.

01 A dedicated tax advisor One named person, not a queue and not whoever is free. They hold your file, they know what you did last year and why, and their number is in your phone. You will not explain your situation from scratch again.	02 Counsel across the whole year A quarterly session on the calendar, a written strategy plan, a mid-year projection, and a year-end review — plus unlimited questions in between. The point is to reach every decision before it hardens into a filing.	03 Everything filed and handled Your returns, your estimates, your notices. Included, not billed. When an envelope arrives from the IRS or a state, you forward it and stop thinking about it — that is the service.
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TWO TRACKS

Built for the two situations that need it.

Same spine — named advisor, quarterly counsel, everything filed. What changes is the work underneath, because a high W-2 and equity package is a different animal from an operating business.

TRACK A High-income individuals	TRACK B Business owners & entities
Large W-2 or professional income, equity compensation, investment and rental portfolios, a liquidity event on the horizon. - Equity compensation — RSU vesting, ISO and NSO exercise timing, 83(b) decisions - Capital gains planning, loss harvesting and holding-period management - Alternative minimum tax exposure modelled before it lands - Net investment income tax and the additional Medicare tax - Charitable strategy — bunching, donor-advised funds, appreciated stock - Backdoor and mega-backdoor Roth mechanics, done correctly - Rental and real estate positions, including passive loss rules - State residency and part-year planning for moves and second homes - Annual gift exclusion use and coordination with your estate attorney	An operating company, or several. Partnerships, S-corps and C-corps, single-state or spread across the country. - Entity structure and elections, reviewed every year rather than once - Owner compensation, distributions and basis tracking - Accountable plan, home office, vehicle and reimbursement policy - Retirement plan design — Solo 401(k), SEP, SIMPLE, cash balance - Qualified business income treatment and how to protect it - Depreciation strategy, bonus versus §179, cost segregation coordination - Multi-state nexus, apportionment and registration monitoring - R&D credit qualification and study coordination - Succession, basis and exit planning well ahead of a sale

INCLUDED IN THE ENGAGEMENT

No line items. No surprise invoices.

Everything below is inside the annual fee. The reason is simple: a client who hesitates before calling their tax advisor is a client who calls too late.

ADVICE & PLANNING	FILING & COMPLIANCE
Quarterly strategy sessions — four a year, scheduled, with an agenda and notes Written annual strategy plan — quantified, with an implementation calendar Mid-year projection — your year run forward while it can still be changed Year-end review — the closing window, worked properly in November Transaction support — call before the purchase, the sale or the exercise Unlimited questions — email or phone, no clock running Second Look on prior years — three filed returns reviewed at onboarding Coordination with your other advisors — attorney, wealth manager, lender	All personal returns — federal and every state you touch All entity returns — 1065, 1120-S or 1120, on Track B Quarterly estimates managed — recalculated, vouchers issued, safe harbour tracked Extensions — filed with a payment estimate, not a guess Notice handling — any IRS or state letter, answered, at no separate fee Examination representation — on returns we prepared Amendments — where they are worth filing Document vault — permanent, and yours whether or not you stay

ONE BOUNDARY, STATED PLAINLY Representation before the IRS is provided only by practitioners authorised under Circular 230, and outcomes in any examination or collection matter depend on your circumstances and on the agency's determination. Nothing in this engagement is a guarantee of a particular tax result — what it guarantees is that someone competent is looking, all year.
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PREMIUM SUPPORT

What “dedicated” actually means here.

Most firms use the word. These are the commitments behind it, and they are in the engagement letter, not just on this page.

RESPONSE One business day Every question gets a substantive answer within one business day — not an acknowledgement, an answer. If it needs research, you get the timeline that day.	ACCESS Direct line, no gate Your advisor's direct number and email. No ticket queue, no general inbox, no re-explaining your situation to whoever picks up.	URGENCY Deadline triage same day Anything with a date on it — a notice, a closing, an exercise window — is read and answered the day it arrives.	CONTINUITY A second who knows you A named backup advisor reads your file too, so holidays, illness and filing season never leave you starting over.
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HOW THE YEAR RUNS

Four quarters, four conversations.

The engagement has a rhythm, and it is the opposite of the usual one — the heavy thinking happens in the quiet months and April is mostly paperwork.

Q1 · JAN — APR Filing Returns prepared and filed. If the other three quarters were done properly, nothing here is news. - All returns, federal and state - K-1s chased on your behalf - Q1 estimate set	Q2 · MAY — JUL Structure The quiet quarter, and the one that moves the number most. Everything structural is cheapest to change now. - Entity and election review - Compensation reset - Retirement plan design	Q3 · AUG — OCT Projection Your year run forward to a written figure, with the levers still available listed against it. - Mid-year projection issued - Estimates re-cut - Equipment and gains timing	Q4 · NOV — DEC Execution The closing window. Everything agreed in Q3 gets done before the year shuts, with a checklist and a deadline each. - Contributions funded - Income and expense timing - Distributions and bonuses set
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FIT

Worth being honest about.

This is a significant annual commitment and it is not right for everyone. We would rather tell you that on the first call than in the second year.

It earns its fee when	It does not, yet, when
- Your income is high enough that timing and structure move real money - You own a business, or several, and the entity questions are live - Equity compensation, real estate or investments make the year complicated - You operate or earn in more than one state - A sale, a purchase or a liquidity event is somewhere on the horizon - You have been surprised by a tax bill more than once	- A straightforward return is genuinely all you need — take a filing package - The business is new and not yet profitable — start with books and estimates - You want a return prepared and no conversation. That is a fair thing to want. - The main problem is a balance owed or unfiled years — start with Audit & Resolution
If any of these is you, we will say so and point you at the right thing. It costs us a sale and saves you a year.	

FEE

Scoped, not listed.

The Standing File is an annual engagement, quoted after a scoping call, because the work genuinely differs — a two-state consultant and a six-entity group are not the same year. What we can promise is that the number is fixed for the term, agreed in writing before anything starts, and does not move because you called too often.

- Annual engagement, billed monthly or annually — your choice
- Fixed for the term. No hourly billing, no per-question charges
- Scope, deliverables and dates set out in a written engagement letter
- Includes the returns, so compare it against what you pay today in total

Request a scoping call

Call 1 (571) 470-3754

	Call me before you sign it. Afterwards I'm just a witness. UNCLE ED
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Pivot Aide Tax Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states. 1 (571) 470-3754 6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	FILE Individual & self-employed Business returns QuickPrepare Prior year & amended Pricing The Standing File	RESOLUTION IRS notices Audit representation Back taxes & collections Unfiled returns All fifty state agencies Audit Shield	RESOURCES & BOOKING Tax calendar & deadlines 2026 tax figures What to bring Official IRS tools Book an appointment Free help & Second Look
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AUDIT & RESOLUTION

This is the part Uncle Ed does.

A notice, an examination, a balance you can't pay, four years you never filed. None of it is the end of anything, and all of it has a process. Federal and state — every state agency in the country.



- Call 1 (571) 470-3754
- Have us read it free

FOUR TIERS

Where your situation lands.

01	Notice response CP2000, CP14, CP501/503/504, LT11, and their state equivalents. We read it, check whether the agency is actually right — often it isn't — draft and file the response, and track it to closure. Most letters end here and never become anything larger.	\$450 PER NOTICE
02	Examination representation We file a power of attorney and deal with the examiner directly. Correspondence, office, or field audit. Document production, responses to information requests, written position memos, and appeal where the position is worth defending. You don't attend.	from \$2,500 SCOPED AFTER REVIEW
03	Collections & resolution Balances owed, liens, levies, wage garnishment. We pull and read your transcripts first, always. Then the right instrument: an installment agreement, currently-not-collectible status, penalty abatement on first-time or reasonable-cause grounds, or an offer in compromise if you genuinely qualify for one.	from \$1,500 SCOPED AFTER REVIEW
04	Back years & unfiled returns Three years or ten. We pull wage-and-income transcripts, reverse substitute-for-return assessments where they exist, reconstruct what's missing, and get you back to compliant — so you can borrow, bid, or just stop thinking about it.	\$350 / year + \$500 RECONSTRUCTION

THE STATE DESK

All fifty state agencies.

Most tax-relief firms only handle the IRS. State agencies move faster and are less forgiving, and they are where multi-state clients get caught out. We work all of them — with the deepest bench in Maryland, Virginia and DC.

- Any state department of revenue or taxation
- Comptroller of Maryland · Virginia Dept. of Taxation · DC OTR
- Multi-state assessments and apportionment disputes
- Sales and use tax audits
- Withholding and employer assessments
- Nexus assessments for remote sellers
- State liens, levies and payment plans

SPECIALTY MATTERS

The harder ones.

Situations that need someone who has seen the situation before, not someone reading the instructions for the first time.

- Innocent spouse and injured spouse relief
- Identity-theft returns and IP PIN recovery
- Employee Retention Credit examinations
- Worker classification — 1099 versus W-2
- Trust fund recovery penalty
- First-time and reasonable-cause abatement
- Transcript analysis and account reconstruction

ON EVERY RETURN · \$75 A YEAR Audit Shield Add it when you file. If that return is ever examined, notice response and examination representation on it are covered — no separate engagement, no new fee.	HOW WE WORK What you can expect One number to call. We read your letter within two business days and tell you the deadline on it. No countdown timers, no red banners, no promises about outcomes — just what the process is and what it costs.
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PLAINLY

Resolution outcomes depend on your financial circumstances and on the agency's own determination. No firm can promise a specific result, a reduced balance, or a percentage — and anyone who does is selling you something. We'll tell you honestly what your options look like before you engage us.

 Pivot Aide Tax Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states. 1 (571) 470-3754 6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	FILE Individual & self-employed Business returns QuickPrepare Prior year & amended Pricing The Standing File	RESOLUTION IRS notices Audit representation Back taxes & collections Unfiled returns All fifty state agencies Audit Shield	RESOURCES & BOOKING Tax calendar & deadlines 2026 tax figures What to bring Official IRS tools Book an appointment Free help & Second Look
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BUSINESS TAX SERVICES

The work that happens the other eleven months.

Filing is the last step. This is everything before it — clean books, current payroll, estimates that don’t surprise you, and a planning retainer that keeps someone looking at your year while you can still change it. Priced on volume, not on hours, so you know the number before the month starts. Month to month — no annual contract.

MONTHLY BOOKKEEPING · TIERED BY EXPENSE VOLUME

Ledger	Up to 2 accounts, under \$25K monthly expenses. Monthly P&L and balance sheet.	\$350 PER MONTH
Ledger Plus	Up to 5 accounts, under \$75K monthly. AP and AR tracking, full monthly close package.	\$650 PER MONTH
Controller	Unlimited accounts, class and department tracking, cash forecast, monthly review call.	\$1,200 PER MONTH

COMPLIANCE OPERATIONS

Payroll	Base plus \$12 per employee per month. Filings, W-2 and 1099 year-end, new-hire reporting. Add \$50 per additional state.	\$125 + PER HEAD
Sales & use tax	Per state. Nexus monitoring, return filing, remittance calendar.	\$150 PER MONTH
Quarterly estimates	Four recalculations a year, vouchers issued, safe-harbour tracking.	\$600 PER YEAR
Catch-up books	Per month of books reconstructed, three-month minimum.	\$400 PER MONTH
Planning retainer	Mid-year projection, entity and compensation review, a strategy session each quarter, unlimited notice review.	\$250 PER MONTH

WORTH DOING THE ARITHMETIC ON

Bookkeeping clients get their entity return at half the price on the filing page. On the Ledger plan that’s \$375 back on a \$750 return — more than a month of bookkeeping, returned to you for handing us clean books.

ADVANCED ADVISORY

For owners, not filers.

Scoped in a conversation and quoted properly. The figures below are where these engagements usually start.

STRUCTURE & COMPENSATION

S-corp election	Form 2553, reasonable-compensation benchmark memo, payroll set-up, accountable plan adopted.	\$1,500
Owner comp plan	Salary and distribution split, basis tracking, loan versus distribution treatment.	\$1,200
Entity structure	Holding company, related-party flows, multi-entity design, state footprint.	\$3,500+
Retirement design	Solo 401(k), SEP, SIMPLE; cash-balance modelling for high earners.	\$1,500

PLANNING & POSITIONS

Annual strategy plan	Written and quantified, with a projected saving and an implementation calendar you can hold us to.	\$2,500+
Multi-state nexus	Economic nexus review, apportionment, registration and unwind plan.	\$2,000
Depreciation strategy	Bonus versus §179, cost-recovery timing across the fixed asset register.	\$1,000
Exam readiness	Pre-examination review of positions, substantiation and records — before anyone is looking.	\$2,500
Cost segregation	Real estate. We manage the specialist study and book the result on your return.	quoted
R&D credit	Qualification review, study coordination, and the credit claimed and defended.	quoted

IF YOU WANT ALL OF IT, ALL YEAR

The Standing File

Everything above, plus your returns, your estimates and your notices — with a dedicated advisor and quarterly counsel, for one annual fee. Our year-round engagement for high-income individuals and business owners.

See The Standing File

 Pivot Aide Tax	FILE	RESOLUTION	RESOURCES & BOOKING
Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states.	Individual & self-employed	IRS notices	Tax calendar & deadlines
1 (571) 470-3754	Business returns	Audit representation	2026 tax figures
6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	QuickPrepare	Back taxes & collections	What to bring
	Prior year & amended	Unfiled returns	Official IRS tools
	Pricing	All fifty state agencies	Book an appointment
	The Standing File	Audit Shield	Free help & Second Look

Prices shown are for the scopes described and are confirmed in writing before work begins. Representation before the Internal Revenue Service is provided only by practitioners authorised under Circular 230. Nothing on this site is a guarantee of any particular outcome; resolution results depend on individual financial circumstances and on agency determination. · Privacy policy · Terms & conditions · Payment policy · Security policy · Disclaimer · Service expectations

FREE HELP

Eight things you can have for nothing.

Every firm says the first consultation is free. This is a longer list than that. Each one has a real limit printed next to it, because an offer with a hidden catch isn’t worth much.

LIMIT · THREE RETURNS, ONCE Second Look Send us your last three filed returns. We read them for missed credits, the wrong filing status, unclaimed depreciation, and the deductions your trade usually forgets. If we find something, we’ll tell you what amending it is worth before you decide anything.	LIMIT · ONE LETTER PER HOUSEHOLD Notice Triage Send the IRS or state letter. Within two business days you get a plain-English read: what it is, what it wants, what the deadline actually is, and what it would cost to handle. Whether or not you hire us.
LIMIT · ONE HOUR Consultation An hour with a person who does this for a living, on the phone, on video, or in person. Bring the messy question — that’s the one worth the hour.	LIMIT · ONCE A YEAR Withholding Checkup We tune your W-4 so you stop lending the government money interest-free, or stop owing every April. Fifteen minutes, and it changes every paycheck for a year.
LIMIT · ONE PAGE, ONE ANSWER Entity Fit Check Should you be an S-corp yet? You get one page with the actual breakeven number for your income — not a general rule of thumb, and not a yes because we’d like to sell you the election.	DOWNLOAD Deduction checklists by trade Separate lists for realtors, contractors, truckers, home-care agencies, salon owners, and rideshare drivers. Written for that trade, not a generic list with the word “business” in front of everything.
CLIENTS · ONE A MONTH Ask Uncle Ed On any paid plan, one tax question a month, answered properly. Not a chatbot and not a knowledge base — an actual answer from an actual preparer.	ALWAYS Document vault A secure portal and a permanent archive of everything we’ve filed for you. It stays reachable whether or not you’re still a client. Your returns are yours.



That letter has a deadline on it. Send it over. We’ll read it today.

UNCLE ED



Pivot Aide Tax

Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states.

1 (571) 470-3754
6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783

FILE

- Individual & self-employed
- Business returns
- QuickPrepare
- Prior year & amended
- Pricing
- The Standing File

RESOLUTION

- IRS notices
- Audit representation
- Back taxes & collections
- Unfiled returns
- All fifty state agencies
- Audit Shield

RESOURCES & BOOKING

- Tax calendar & deadlines
- 2026 tax figures
- What to bring
- Official IRS tools
- Book an appointment
- Free help & Second Look

TAX RESOURCES

The things people call us to ask.

Deadlines, the numbers that actually changed this year, what to bring, and plain-English answers to the questions that come up every week. Free to use, whether or not you file with us.

WHAT'S NEXT

The dates that are actually coming.

Not a generic calendar starting in January — the deadlines ahead of you from today. Anything marked in gold is inside the next ninety days.

15 Sep 2026 TUESDAY	Q3 estimated tax · extended partnership and S-corp returns Third-quarter estimate for the 2026 tax year, and the final deadline for 1065 and 1120-S returns that were extended in March.	SELF-EMPLOYED PARTNERSHIPS S-CORPS
15 Oct 2026 THURSDAY	Extended individual returns Last day for 2025 Form 1040 returns filed on extension. There is no further extension — after this, late-filing penalties start accruing.	INDIVIDUALS SOLE PROPRIETORS
Nov — Dec 2026 PLANNING WINDOW	Year-end moves Retirement funding, equipment purchases, income and expense timing, charitable gifts, bonuses and distributions. Almost every lever closes at midnight on 31 December.	EVERYONE WITH SOMETHING TO DECIDE
31 Dec 2026 THURSDAY	The 2026 tax year closes Last day for most deductible actions. IRA contributions are the notable exception — those run to the filing deadline.	EVERYONE
15 Jan 2027 FRIDAY	Q4 estimated tax Final 2026 estimate. Paying it on time is often what keeps the underpayment penalty off the return.	SELF-EMPLOYED INVESTORS
1 Feb 2027 MONDAY	W-2 and 1099 furnishing deadline Employers and payers must get W-2s and most 1099s to recipients and to the agencies. The statutory date is 31 January, which falls on a Sunday, so it moves to the next business day. If you pay contractors, this is your deadline, not theirs.	EMPLOYERS ANYONE ISSUING 1099S
15 Mar 2027 MONDAY	Partnership and S-corp returns Forms 1065 and 1120-S, or the extension to 15 September. K-1s flow from here, so a late entity return holds up every owner's personal return.	PARTNERSHIPS S-CORPS
15 Apr 2027 THURSDAY	Individual and C-corp returns · Q1 estimate · IRA deadline Form 1040 and Form 1120, or an extension. Also the first 2027 estimate, and the last day to make a 2026 IRA or HSA contribution.	INDIVIDUALS C-CORPS
ON EXTENSIONS An extension gives you more time to file, never more time to pay. If you expect to owe, the payment is still due on the original date — otherwise interest and the failure-to-pay penalty run from that day, extension or not. We estimate the payment and file the extension together.		

TAX YEAR 2026

The numbers that matter this year.

Figures for the 2026 tax year — the year you are living in now, and the one your planning decisions still affect. Sourced from the IRS; we update this page when the agency does.

STANDARD DEDUCTION		RETIREMENT CONTRIBUTIONS	
Single or married filing separately	\$16,100	401(k), 403(b), 457, TSP deferral	\$24,500
Married filing jointly	\$32,200	Catch-up, age 50+	\$8,000
Head of household	\$24,150	Higher catch-up, ages 60–63	\$11,250
Additional deduction, age 65+ Temporary, 2025–2028. Phases out above \$75,000 MAGI (\$150,000 joint).	\$6,000 per eligible person	IRA contribution	\$7,500
MARGINAL RATES · TAXABLE INCOME		IRA catch-up, age 50+	\$1,100
10% Single / married filing jointly	to \$12,400 to \$24,800	SIMPLE plan deferral Higher limit for applicable plans: \$18,100	\$17,000
12%	over \$12,400 over \$24,800	SIMPLE catch-up, 50+ / 60–63	\$4,000 \$5,250
22%	over \$50,400 over \$100,800	Roth IRA phase-out Single or head of household / joint	\$153k–\$168k \$242k–\$252k
24%	over \$105,700 over \$211,400	Traditional IRA deductibility If covered by a workplace plan. Single / joint.	\$81k–\$91k \$129k–\$149k
32%	over \$201,775 over \$403,550	BUSINESS & MILEAGE	
35%	over \$256,225 over \$512,450	Standard mileage — business	72.5¢ per mile
37%	over \$640,600 over \$768,700	Standard mileage — medical or moving	20.5¢ per mile
HEALTH & BENEFITS		Standard mileage — charitable	14¢ per mile
HSA contribution — self-only	\$4,400	State and local tax cap Phases down above roughly \$505,000 MAGI, floor \$10,000.	\$40,400
HSA contribution — family	\$8,750	TEMPORARY DEDUCTIONS · 2025 – 2028	
HSA catch-up, age 55+	\$1,000	Qualified tips Phases out above \$150,000 (\$300,000 joint).	up to \$25,000
HDHP minimum deductible Self-only / family	\$1,700 \$3,400	Qualified overtime \$25,000 joint. Same phase-out.	up to \$12,500
HDHP out-of-pocket maximum Self-only / family	\$8,500 \$17,000	Car loan interest Loans originated after 31 Dec 2024. Phases out above \$100,000 (\$200,000 joint).	up to \$10,000
Health FSA salary reduction	\$3,400	TRANSFERS & AMT	
Qualified transportation benefit	\$340 per month	Annual gift tax exclusion	\$19,000 per recipient
		Estate tax basic exclusion	\$15,000,000
		AMT exemption Unmarried / married filing jointly	\$90,100 \$140,200

Figures are for tax year 2026 and come from IRS Revenue Procedure 2025–32, IRS Notice IR–2025–111, Revenue Procedure 2025–19 and the 2026 standard mileage rate announcement. Reference only — your situation decides which of these apply, and several phase out with income.

PLAIN ENGLISH

Six things worth understanding.

Written the way we would explain them on the phone, because that is where most of these questions actually get asked.

NOTICES A CP2000 is not a bill It is a <i>proposed</i> change — the IRS matched a form it received against your return and found a gap. You normally have 30 days to agree or disagree. A surprising share are wrong, or right about the income and wrong about the basis. Never pay one before someone reads it.	ESTIMATES Why you owe every April Nothing withholds tax from self-employment, investment or rental income. The fix is quarterly estimates. Pay the lesser of 90% of this year's tax or 100% of last year's — 110% if last year's AGI topped \$150,000 — and the underpayment penalty goes away.	ENTITY When an S-corp starts to pay The saving is on self-employment tax, and it only exists once profit comfortably exceeds a reasonable salary for your role. Below that, the payroll and filing costs eat it. The salary is not optional and not a number you pick — it has to be defensible.
RECORDS How long to keep things Three years is the general rule. Six if you omitted more than 25% of your gross income. Employment tax records, four. Property records until three years after you sell it. If you never filed, or filed fraudulently, there is no limit at all.	MULTI-STATE Where you actually owe Your resident state taxes everything; other states tax what you earned there, and your home state usually credits you for it. Remote work, a rental elsewhere, or a mid-year move each create a return most people miss — and states are getting better at noticing.	EXTENSIONS An extension buys time to file Not time to pay. File one and you avoid the failure-to-file penalty, which is ten times heavier than the failure-to-pay penalty. But interest and the smaller penalty still run from the original date on anything unpaid.

 None of this is complicated. It's just unfamiliar, and it arrives when you're busy.
UNCLE ED

BEFORE YOU FILE

What to have ready.

The portal gives you a checklist built for your situation. This is the short version, so you can start gathering before you book anything.

EVERYONE	SELF-EMPLOYED AND BUSINESS OWNERS
— Last year's filed return	— Profit and loss and balance sheet, or the bookkeeping file
— Photo ID and Social Security numbers for everyone on the return	— Bank and credit card statements for every business account
— W-2s, and 1099s of every letter — NEC, MISC, INT, DIV, B, R, G, K	— Mileage log, or total business and total miles for the year
— 1095-A if you had marketplace health coverage	— Home office square footage and total home square footage
— 1098 for mortgage interest, 1098-T for tuition, 1098-E for student loan interest	— Asset purchases over \$2,500 with dates and amounts
— Bank routing and account number for the refund or payment	— Payroll reports and copies of 1099s you issued
— Any IRS or state letters received since your last filing	— K-1s from any partnership or S-corp you hold
	— Estimated tax payments made, with dates

OFFICIAL TOOLS

Straight to the source.

Everything here is a government site. We link to them rather than reproducing them, because these are the versions that stay current — and because nobody should take a tax figure from a marketing page without being able to check it.

Where's My Refund Refund status, updated daily. Available about 24 hours after an e-filed return is accepted. irs.gov/refunds	IRS Online Account Your balance, payment history, notices and transcripts in one place. Worth setting up before you need it. irs.gov/payments/onLine-account
Get Transcript Wage and income transcripts — what the IRS was actually told about you. The first thing we pull on any back-year matter. irs.gov/individuals/get-transcript	IRS Direct Pay Pay a balance or an estimate straight from a bank account, no fee. Keep the confirmation number. irs.gov/payments/direct-pay
Withholding Estimator Check whether your W-4 is set right. Or let us do it — the Withholding Checkup is free. irs.gov/individuals/tax-withholding-estimator	Identity Protection PIN A six-digit code that stops anyone else filing a return under your Social Security number. irs.gov/identity-theft-fraud-scams
Comptroller of Maryland Maryland returns, payments, notices and business tax accounts. marylandtaxes.gov	Virginia Department of Taxation Virginia individual and business filing, payments and correspondence. tax.virginia.gov

Filing in another state? We work all fifty — ask and we'll point you at the right agency, or just handle it.

WHAT THIS PAGE IS AND ISN'T

General information, current as of September 2026, not advice about your situation. Tax figures change every year and most of them phase out with income. Before you act on anything here, let us look at your actual numbers — the consultation is free.

Pivot Aide Tax Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states. 1 (571) 470–3754 6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	FILE Individual & self-employed Business returns QuickPrepare Prior year & amended Pricing The Standing File	RESOLUTION IRS notices Audit representation Back taxes & collections Unfiled returns All fifty state agencies Audit Shield	RESOURCES & BOOKING Tax calendar & deadlines 2026 tax figures What to bring Official IRS tools Book an appointment Free help & Second Look
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Prices shown are for the scopes described and are confirmed in writing before work begins. Representation before the Internal Revenue Service is provided only by practitioners authorised under Circular 230. Nothing on this site is a guarantee of any particular outcome; resolution results depend on individual financial circumstances and on agency determination. · [Privacy policy](#) · [Terms & conditions](#) · [Payment policy](#) · [Security policy](#) · [Disclaimer](#) · [Service expectations](#)

APPOINTMENTS

Book time with a person.

Not a form that disappears into an inbox. You pick a slot, you get a confirmation the same business day, and a preparer who has read your file turns up to it.

[See what else is free](#)

[Or call 1 \(571\) 470-3754](#)



WHAT YOU CAN BOOK

Seven kinds of appointment.

Pick the one that matches your question. If you pick wrong we'll move you, at no charge — we would rather you got the right hour than the tidy one.

ANYONE Free consultation An hour to talk through whatever the situation is — a first filing, a business you just started, a year that went sideways. Bring the messy question. That's the one worth the hour. 60 minutes · No charge	AFTER YOU CHOOSE A PACKAGE Filing kickoff We walk your document checklist together, confirm the package is the right one before any work starts, and agree the timeline for your return. 30 minutes · Included	PRIORITY SLOTS HELD DAILY Notice or audit intake You have a letter, an examination, a balance, or years you haven't filed. Bring the notice. We read it, tell you the real deadline, and set out what handling it involves and costs. 45 minutes · Triage free
AUGUST – OCTOBER Mid-year projection Your year run forward to a written number, while there is still time to change it. Includes what to do about it and by when. 60 minutes · Included on retainer	ANY TIME Entity & S-corp review Should you elect, and is this the year? We bring your actual breakeven, a reasonable compensation range, and an honest answer if the answer is not yet. 45 minutes · Fit check free	THE STANDING FILE Strategy scoping call For anyone considering the year-round engagement. We assess the situation honestly, tell you whether it earns its fee, and quote only if it does. 45 minutes · No charge
NOVEMBER – DECEMBER ONLY Year-end planning The last moves that still count for the closing tax year — retirement funding, equipment, income timing, distributions. Booked out early; don't leave it to late December. 60 minutes · Included on retainer		

SCHEDULER EMBEDS HERE

Pick a time that works

Live availability, automatic confirmation and reminders, and a rescheduling link in every email. Drop your booking tool's embed into this block.

HOW WE MEET

- Video** — the default. A link arrives with your confirmation.
- Phone** — say so when you book and we'll call you.
- In person** — Hyattsville, Maryland, by arrangement.

WHAT TO HAVE READY

- Your most recent filed return
- Any letters from the IRS or a state agency
- A year-to-date P&L or bank summary, if there's a business
- The question you actually want answered — write it down first

CONFIRMATION Same business day Every booking is confirmed by a person before the end of the business day, with the preparer's name on it.	URGENT MATTERS Two business days Anyone with a dated notice gets a slot within two business days. If the deadline is tighter than that, call rather than book.	CHANGES Reschedule free Up to 24 hours before, from the link in your confirmation. No fee, no explanation needed.
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SEASON NOTE

From late January through April, appointments book two to three weeks ahead and the last week before a deadline is usually gone. If you know you will need us in the spring, take a slot in the autumn — it costs nothing to move it later.

MEET UNCLE ED

Everybody’s got an Uncle Sam.

Not everybody’s got an Uncle Ed.

Ed is an owl, and he has been doing this a long time. He has seen every letter the agency sends and he is not impressed by any of them. He’s the relative you call before you call a lawyer — the one who reads the notice, puts it down, and says *okay, here’s what this actually is*.

Owls see in the dark, hear what’s hidden, and hunt without making a sound. That’s more or less the job: find what’s buried in a return, spot the risk before the agency does, and handle it quietly.

There’s a division of labour here. **Uncle Sam handles compliance** — the forms, the deadlines, the amount due on a year that has already closed. **Uncle Ed handles strategy** — the twelve months of decisions that determine what Sam ends up calculating. One of them looks backwards. The other gets there first.



PLACEHOLDER · FINAL ART PER BRIEF

HOW HE TALKS

Five rules, and one he won’t break.

RULE 01 Calm first Ed never panics, and never makes you panic. Fear is the competition’s instrument, not ours.	RULE 02 Plain words “The IRS thinks you left off \$8,400 of income” — not “CP2000 underreporter inquiry.”	RULE 03 Short sentences He’s talking to you. He isn’t filing a brief.
RULE 04 Honest about bad news If you owe it, he says so. There’s no version of this where being told what you want to hear helps.	RULE 05 Dry, never jokey One wry beat, then back to work. He’s warm. He isn’t the comic relief.	THE ONE HE WON’T BREAK He defends against the letter, not the government Uncle Sam is entitled to what he’s owed. Our job is making sure the number is right and you’re treated correctly. That’s the whole posture.

THINGS ED SAYS

In his own words.

- “Uncle Sam isn’t the enemy. He’s just very organised. So are we.”
- “He gets exactly what he’s owed. Not a dollar more.”
- “Most of these letters are wrong about something. Let’s find out which part.”
- “Four years unfiled. That’s fixable. It’s happened before.”
- “Bring the messy question. That’s the one worth the hour.”

THINGS ED DOESN’T SAY

And won’t.

- “Beat the IRS” or “fight the government”
- Anything about pennies on the dollar
- Anything a tax protester would nod along to
- A promised outcome, figure, or percentage
- A joke at a frightened person’s expense

BEHIND THE OWL

Uncle Ed is the friendly face on a firm of accountants and preparers working out of Hyattsville, Maryland and Northern Virginia. Real credentials, real licensing, listed on the contact page. He’s who greets you. They’re who does the work.

 Pivot Aide Tax	FILE	RESOLUTION	RESOURCES & BOOKING
Income tax is all we do. Year-round strategy, filing, compliance and IRS resolution for individuals and small businesses in all fifty states.	Individual & self-employed	IRS notices	Tax calendar & deadlines
	Business returns	Audit representation	2026 tax figures
	QuickPrepare	Back taxes & collections	What to bring
	Prior year & amended	Unfiled returns	Official IRS tools
1 (571) 470-3754	Pricing	All fifty state agencies	Book an appointment
6475 New Hampshire Ave, Hyattsville, MD 20783	The Standing File	Audit Shield	Free help & Second Look